



On-the-go connection

Major operators such as Airtel, Vodafone, Idea and Aircel will soon give you uninterrupted mobile connectivity on Express trains <http://dgit.in/JiIld4>

Agent 001

a physical QWERTY keypad – critical for comfort. For someone who doesn't want a smartphone to be a learning curve, or isn't willing to spend time getting the hang of a newer OS, familiarity is the best option. The app ecosystem isn't very wide for Symbian and BlackBerry, but then again, we don't assume you'd be interested in downloading too many apps anyway!

The absolute geek

If you're in this category, you're the typical user who wants to tinker with the phone's software quite a bit. That'll include rooting/jail breaking (though I don't approve of or recommend it), custom software, over-clocking... the works. While these are unadvisable, as doing them creates issues with the warranty, those of you who must do it will do it! Which is why Android is the best option for you. You can get hundreds of custom ROMs on the internet that you can install on



HTC One X

your phone. The process isn't simple, but the geeks are doing it. It can also be done with iOS, following a simpler process. But then again, with Android, you get a wider variety of phones at multiple price points.

The no-nonsense user

The iOS (okay, Android fanboys will probably be sharpening their knives at the moment!) offers possibly the best blend of functionality, performance and a slick user experience. If you want a phone that does everything, I suggest checking out the iPhone. With the 3GS starting at around ₹19k, the entry price

barrier has come down considerably. Having said that, Android is catching up superbly with the latest ICS update. Get a phone with Android version 4.0 and you'll be sorted.

Windows Phone 7, post the Mango update, looks like a very neat package. While it is still to really catch on, we quite like the updated OS – it works well out of the box. The fact that the performance of the OS isn't lagging, even on a phone with 512 MB of RAM helps a graphic intensive, yet easy-to-navigate UI.



BlackBerry Bold Touch 9900

The business user

What you want is simplicity but you'll not compromise on features. You have the daily staple diet of emails, lots of messages, a bit of web browsing and a considerable amount of calls. Ideally, a phone with a QWERTY keypad will suit you the best – an immense help when typing those long mails and messages.

BlackBerry smartphones are possibly the benchmark, and the Nokia E-series phones are a solid alternative. You'll probably have to buy a BlackBerry if your organization demands it. The Curve series range starts at about ₹9k, while the latest Bold 9900 with an amazing touchscreen and QWERTY is available for around ₹30k.

If the email setup at your workplace isn't locked to one type of device, I suggest

checking out the Nokia E-series smartphones as

well, particularly the new Nokia E6 (touch + QWERTY) and the slightly ageing but still brilliant E72 to fulfill your needs. 



Nokia Lumia 800

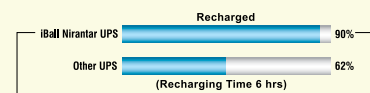


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